

Verdant Peak Technologies - Company FAQs

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General

Q: What are VPT's standard working hours? A: Standard hours are 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM local time, Monday through Friday, with a one-hour unpaid lunch break, totaling 40 hours per week. Some departments, such as Customer Support, operate on shift schedules communicated separately by their managers.

Q: Does VPT support hybrid or remote work? A: Yes. VPT operates a Hybrid Work Model requiring at least three in-office days per week (Tuesday-Thursday are Core Collaboration Days). Fully remote arrangements can be requested on a case-by-case basis and require joint manager and HR approval.

Q: How do I update my personal details (address, emergency contact, bank account)? A: All personal details can be updated directly through the Employee Self-Service (ESS) portal under "My Profile." Bank account changes for payroll require an additional one-time verification step and typically take effect from the next pay cycle.

Q: Who do I contact if I have an HR question not covered here? A: Submit a ticket through the "Ask HR" portal, or reach out to your assigned HR Business Partner. General queries are typically answered within 2 working days.

Leave and Time Off

Q: How many vacation days do I get per year? A: Regular Full-Time employees accrue 20 days of Annual Leave per year (25 days for Senior Manager and above), accrued monthly. Full details are in the Leave Policy.

Q: Can I carry forward unused vacation days? A: Yes, up to a maximum of 10 days may be carried forward into the following calendar year; any balance beyond that is forfeited on December 31, subject to local law.

Q: Do I need a doctor's note for sick leave? A: Only for sick leave exceeding two consecutive working days. A medical certificate must be submitted to HR within 3 working days of returning to work.

Q: How much parental leave is available? A: 26 weeks of paid Maternity Leave, 2 weeks of paid Paternity Leave, and 12 weeks of paid Adoption Leave for employees adopting a child under 12. See the Leave Policy for eligibility and notice requirements.

Q: How do I apply for leave? A: All leave must be requested and approved through the Time-Off Portal, part of the Employee Self-Service system. Approval timelines vary by leave type and duration.

Payroll and Compensation

Q: When is payday? A: Employees are paid monthly, on the last working day of each month, via direct bank transfer. Payslips are available on the ESS portal within three working days after payday.

Q: What should I do if there's an error in my paycheck? A: Report the discrepancy to the Payroll team within 15 calendar days of the pay date through the "Ask Payroll" ticketing system, along with details of the expected versus received amount.

Q: When does the annual compensation review happen? A: The annual compensation review cycle runs each April, with merit increases and bonus payouts evaluated based on the prior year's performance ratings.

Q: Am I eligible for overtime pay? A: Non-exempt employees are compensated at 1.5 times their standard hourly rate for hours worked beyond 40 in a week, provided overtime is approved in advance by their manager.

Benefits

Q: When does my health insurance start? A: Health insurance coverage begins on your first day of employment — there is no waiting period for the primary Group Health Insurance plan.

Q: Can I add family members to my health plan? A: Yes, coverage extends to your spouse and up to 3 dependent children automatically. Parents or parents-in-law can be added under the optional Parental Health Cover, funded partly through payroll deduction.

Q: What is the company match for retirement savings? A: VPT matches 100% of the first 4% of employee contributions and 50% of the next 2%, for a maximum Company contribution of 5% of base salary. Employees are immediately vested in their own contributions; Company matching vests fully after 3 years.

Q: How does the Employee Stock Purchase Plan work? A: Eligible employees (post-probation) can contribute 1-15% of base salary to purchase VPT stock at a 15% discount, during 6-month offering periods opening each May and November.

Q: Is there a wellness or gym benefit? A: Yes, employees can be reimbursed up to \$600 per year for gym memberships or fitness expenses under the Wellness Reimbursement Program, claimed quarterly.

IT and Technology

Q: What do I do if I lose my laptop or it's stolen? A: Report it to the IT Service Desk within 4 hours of discovery so the device can be remotely wiped and access revoked immediately.

Q: Can I use my personal phone or laptop for work? A: Yes, under the BYOD (Bring Your Own Device) program, but the device must first be enrolled in the Company's Mobile Device Management platform, which enforces a minimum passcode and allows wiping of Company data only.

Q: Can I use ChatGPT or other AI tools for work tasks? A: Only Company-approved and vetted GenAI tools may be used for work purposes, and Confidential or Restricted data (including customer data or source code) must never be entered into any unapproved AI tool. Check the IT Service Catalog for the current list of approved tools.

Q: How often do I need to change my password? A: Every 180 days. Passwords must be at least 14 characters and include an uppercase letter, a number, and a special character; Multi-Factor Authentication is mandatory on all Company systems.

Q: Who do I contact for IT support? A: The IT Service Desk is available 24/7 via the internal Service Catalog portal, phone, or chat for both routine requests and urgent security incidents.

Travel and Expenses

Q: How far in advance should I book business travel? A: At least 7 working days before domestic travel and 15 working days before international travel, submitted for manager approval via the Travel & Expense Portal.

Q: What is the daily meal allowance for business travel? A: Per diem varies by city tier: \$85/day for Tier 1 cities, \$65/day for Tier 2, and \$45/day for Tier 3, covering all meals without requiring itemized receipts.

Q: How do I submit travel expenses for reimbursement? A: Submit all expenses via the Travel & Expense Portal within 15 calendar days of trip completion, with itemized receipts for any single expense over \$25. Approved claims are reimbursed via payroll within 10 working days.

Q: What travel class am I entitled to? A: Economy for flights under 6 hours. For flights over 6 hours, Premium Economy is available to Directors (L6) and above, and Business Class to Vice Presidents (L8) and above.

Conduct and Workplace Concerns

Q: How do I report a harassment or ethics concern? A: You can raise it with your manager, HR Business Partner, the Ethics & Compliance team, or the independent, confidential Ethics Hotline, available 24/7 with anonymous reporting options.

Q: Will I face retaliation for reporting a concern in good faith? A: No. VPT strictly prohibits retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith or participates in an investigation, and retaliation is itself treated as a serious Code of Conduct violation.

Q: Do I need to disclose a personal relationship with a colleague I manage? A: Yes, any reporting relationship or close personal relationship between a manager and a direct or indirect

report must be disclosed to HR and the Ethics & Compliance team so appropriate safeguards can be put in place.

Career and Learning

Q: How do I apply for an internal role at VPT? A: Once you've been in your current role for at least 12 months (9 months with manager endorsement for high performers), you can apply through the Internal Careers Portal.

Q: Does VPT offer a learning and development budget? A: Yes, employees receive a \$1,500 annual Learning & Development stipend for external courses, certifications, and conferences, subject to manager approval, plus a separate Tuition Reimbursement Program of up to \$5,250/year for qualifying degree programs.

Q: How does the performance review process work? A: VPT uses quarterly OKR check-ins plus a formal annual review each March, resulting in a rating on a five-point scale that feeds into the April compensation review cycle.